

Large Language Models in Academic Work

— Guo Jiale · 郭嘉乐

A small-scale questionnaire study on adoption, trust, and academic-integrity concerns among university students

Topic: LLM use in coursework & research

Responses: 26 valid

Questions: 5

Group: Solo (1 member)

1 Introduction & Research Questions

Large Language Models (LLMs) such as ChatGPT have rapidly become embedded in students' daily learning routines. This study investigates how university students actually use LLMs in academic contexts, how much they trust the outputs, and how they perceive the accompanying academic-integrity risks.

Three research questions guide the survey:

- ▶ **RQ1** — How frequently and for what purposes do students use LLMs in academic work?
- ▶ **RQ2** — How reliable do students consider LLM-generated academic content?
- ▶ **RQ3** — What concerns do students hold regarding academic integrity, and what regulatory stance do they expect from universities?

2 Key Figures at a Glance

26

VALID RESPONSES

96%

WEEKLY+ USERS

69%

SOMEWHAT TRUST

81%

WANT GUIDANCE

Adoption is near-universal, yet trust is moderate and integrity anxiety is widespread — a clear mismatch that calls for institutional guidance rather than prohibition.

3 Questionnaire Design

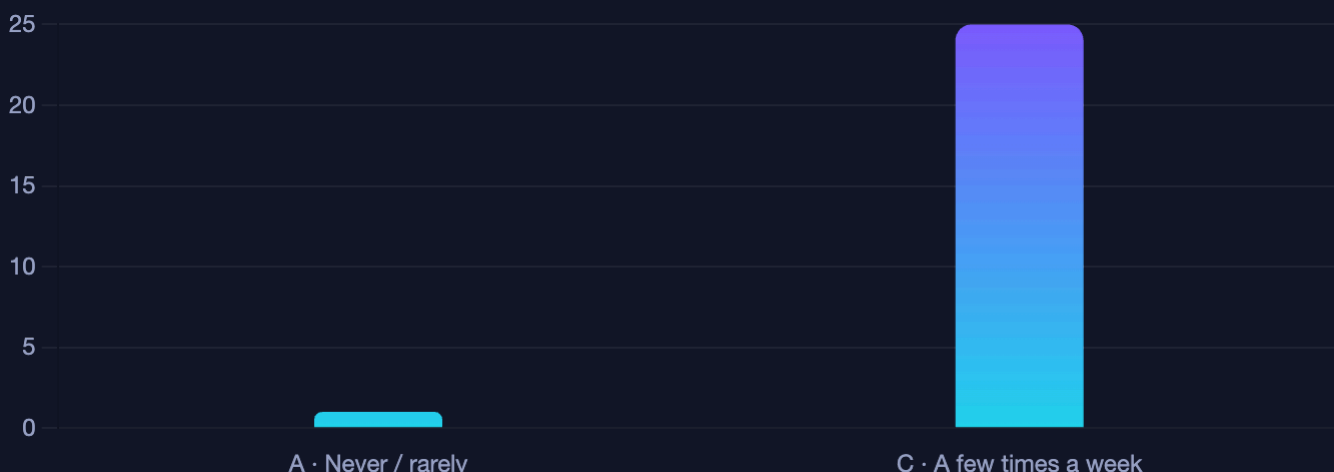
The questionnaire contains five items and fits on a single A4 page. It was distributed via Tencent Questionnaire (腾讯问卷), targeting university students.

- ▶ **Q1 (Frequency)** — single choice, from "never/rarely" to "daily".
- ▶ **Q2 (Use cases)** — multiple choice: information retrieval & brainstorming, translation & polishing, coding, summarising papers, others.
- ▶ **Q3 (Reliability)** — single choice on a four-point perceived-accuracy scale.
- ▶ **Q4 (Integrity concern)** — single choice on worry frequency.
- ▶ **Q5 (Expected university stance)** — single choice.

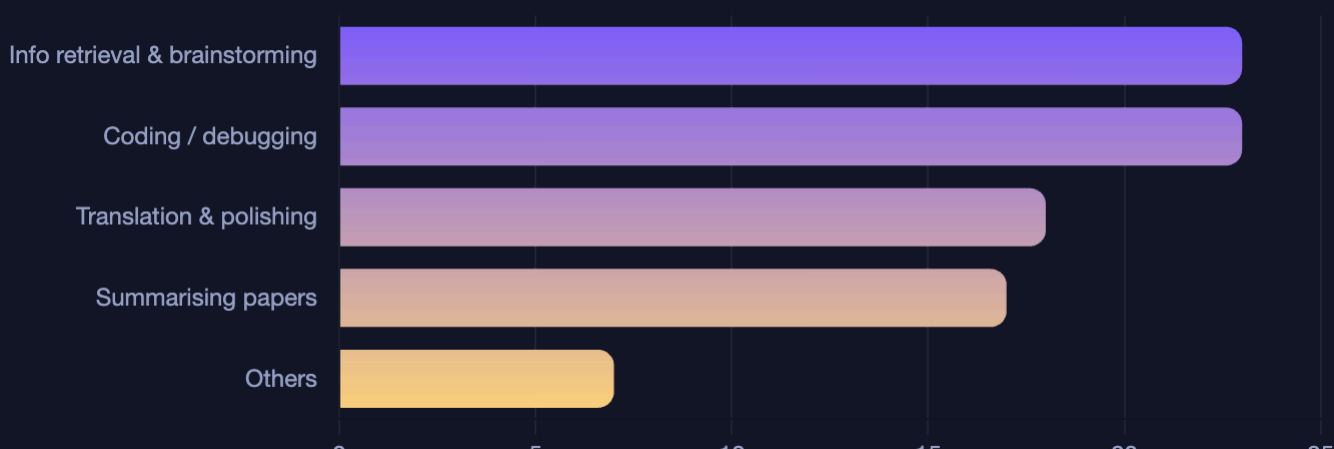
26 responses were collected; all passed the platform's validity check (0 invalid), exceeding the 20-response minimum.

4 Data Organization & Analysis

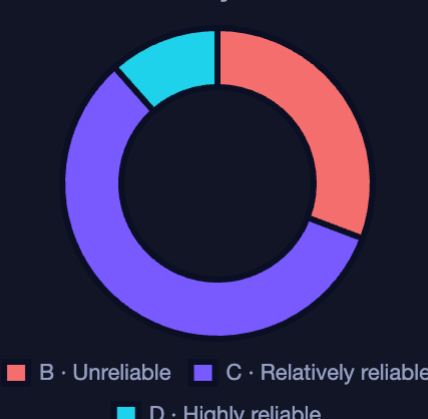
Q1 · Usage Frequency (n = 26)



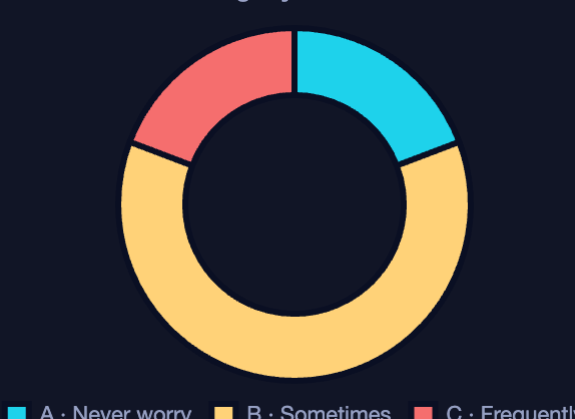
Q2 · Main Academic Use Cases (multi-select)



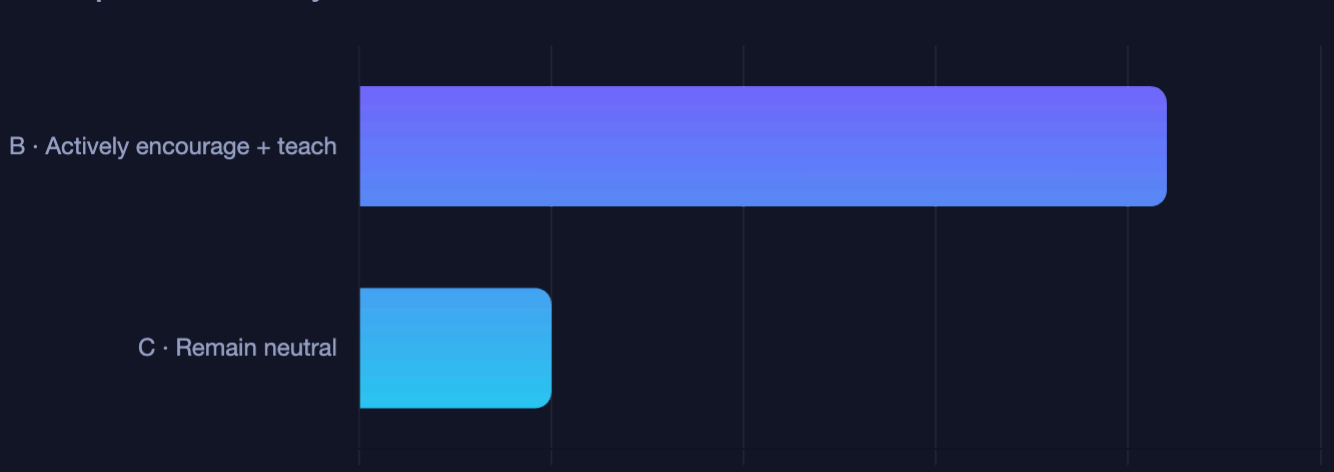
Q3 · Perceived Reliability



Q4 · Academic-Integrity Concern



Q5 · Expected University Stance



Reading the data: 25 of 26 respondents (96%) use LLMs "a few times a week", confirming deep penetration into study habits. Use is dominated by information retrieval/brainstorming and coding (88% each). Yet only 12% regard outputs as "highly reliable"; 58% place them in the cautious "relatively reliable" tier, and 31% find them unreliable. Correspondingly, 62% sometimes worry about academic-integrity violations, while 81% want universities to *actively encourage and teach* proper use rather than ban or ignore it.

5 Discussion & Conclusion

The results reveal a striking **adoption–trust gap**. Students have integrated LLMs into nearly every academic workflow, but their confidence in the outputs lags far behind: most treat LLM content as a draft requiring verification rather than a finished answer. This pragmatic scepticism is healthy, yet it coexists with genuine anxiety — only 19% never worry about integrity, and the boundary between legitimate assistance and misconduct remains blurry to most.

The near-consensus (81%) in favour of *active encouragement plus instruction* is the most policy-relevant finding. Students are not asking for permission to cheat; they are asking for clear rules and training. A limitation of this study is its small, convenience sample (n = 26) drawn mainly through personal networks, which restricts generalisability. Future work could expand the sample, add open-ended items, and compare disciplines. In conclusion, universities should respond to widespread LLM adoption not with prohibition, but with explicit integrity guidelines and courses on critical, verifiable use.

6 Member Responsibilities

This project was completed independently by the author, **Guo Jiale (郭嘉乐)**, as a single-member group. All work — topic selection, questionnaire design, data collection, analysis, visualisation, and report writing — was carried out solely by the author.